

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

# checklist

Items with state markers — done, partial, failed, unknown, to do, skipped.

# The checklist tracks readiness in six answers.

- ✓ Done rows take a solid check
- Half-done rows show the dash
- ✕ Failed rows take the red cross
- ⊕ Unsettled rows ring a question mark
- Open rows stay an empty ring
- ⌕ Descoped rows get the slash

# Nine rows is where the checklist overflows.

- ✓ The first rows land while attention is fresh
- ✓ Sixteen words is the budget a stress row may spend
- ✓ Three checks in a row read as momentum
- A dash admits the honest middle state
- ✗ A red cross marks the check that failed
- ? A ringed question admits what is unknown
- Late rows stay short; the audience is counting now
- ✍ ~~The slash records what was cut, visibly~~
- ✓ Nine is the last row this layout seats

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# When NOT to reach for checklist.

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## All-done lists

If every item is `[x]` the state markers are decoration. Use `list` (or its `takeaway` variant) for celebratory recaps; checklist earns its weight when the mix matters.

## Long per-item prose

Each item is one short line. If a row needs a sentence of explanation, the right home is cards-stack or list-tabular.

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## Custom state markers

Only the six markers — `[x]` `[-]` `[!]` `[?]` `[ ]` `[/]` — map to the mark palette. Anything else in brackets (`[X]`, `[~]`, `[>]`) renders as literal text and breaks the visual contract. `[X]` is the trap: GitHub-flavored markdown reads it as a checked box, and it does not draw a mark here.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`list` — items have no state — just bullets

`list-tabular` — rows need a label-plus-description structure,  
not state

`cards-stack` — each item needs two sentences of body